GinCol Lab · Aula

Student worksheet

Philosophy · 1st year of Bachillerato · What is philosophy and what is it for? · Class 4 of 7 · With Javier

The branches of philosophy, then and now

Class video: https://youtu.be/Gl4qx1pCenk

The code leads to the video.

Name: _____ Date: _____

Before you start

1. Which branches of philosophy do you know, even if only by name? Write down all the ones you can think of.

2. Almost four centuries ago, physics was part of philosophy. What do you think has happened to philosophy since then? Answer in one sentence.

3. **At the end of the class.** Reread your two answers. Which branches would you add? Would you change your sentence? Why?

While you watch the video

1. What did Descartes put in the roots, the trunk and the branches of his tree? Where were physics, medicine and mechanics?

2. According to Russell, why does a subject stop being called philosophy? Which other science broke away at the end of the 19th century?

3. **Your prediction.** With so many branches leaving, is philosophy running out of branches, or is it growing new ones? Why?

4. Fill in the table of the eight questions (below) as the branches grow.

5. Why does the class say that the branches are ways of asking, rather than topics?

6. What does the Greek title of the *Metaphysics* mean? On the shelf of scrolls, what does the horizontal arrow say, and what does the vertical one say? What did Aristotle call that kind of knowledge?

7. **Stop and think.** Is it fair for a machine to decide whom a company hires? Which branch does that question belong to? Only one?

8. What are Aristotle's three groups of knowledge? Where does the class put each of today's branches? Why is logic left out?

9. Where does philosophy grow new branches? For each one, say which science it crosses with and write one of its questions.

10. What do ventilators, and the regulation that governs the Medicine degree, have to do with bioethics?

11. How is the trolley problem different from that of a driverless car?

12. The philosophy of science asks what makes something science. What did Popper answer, and what happened at the 1919 eclipse? What is a paradigm, according to Kuhn? And what did Feyerabend argue?

13. The morning star and the evening star are the same planet: why don't the two names say the same thing? What turn did Wittgenstein take in his *Philosophical Investigations*? And according to Austin, what is someone doing when they say «I do» at their wedding?

14. What is the circle of those who count? How far do Singer, with Bentham's question, and Leopold take it? And in time?

15. **From memory.** Before Javier says them, write down Kant's four questions.

16. Which branch does Kant give to each of his four questions? What does it mean that religion is «thought out by reason»?

The eight questions

The question to the assistant	Its branch	That branch's underlying question
What is it, deep down?		
If it tells you something, how do you know it's true?		
What it says: is it well reasoned, or does it just sound good?		
Should you use it to do your homework?		
Who decides what it can do, and what it can't?		
If it paints a picture, is it art?		
If it writes like us, what makes us human?		
Does it think?		

The new branches:

New branch	Crosses with…	One of its questions
Philosophy of mind		
Bioethics		
Ethics of artificial intelligence		
Philosophy of science		
Philosophy of language		
Environmental ethics		

In class: one object, seven questions

Your group gets a card with an object.

1. **Your prediction**, without talking to anyone: how many of the seven branches fit your object?

2. Write seven questions about the object, one per branch, each on a slip of paper. Two rules: the name of the branch can't appear in the question, and the question can't be answered with a fact. On the back, in pencil, the branch you had in mind.

3. **Blind.** Swap slips with another group and give a branch to each of their questions, without looking at the back. Then compare. Where you don't agree, who is right? Can both groups be right?

4. Stick your questions on the board, under «knowing», «acting» or «making»; the logic ones go in the margin. Where have aesthetics and anthropology ended up?

5. Write a question about your object that crosses at least two branches, and say which ones: .....

For you

1. Of the seven underlying questions, which one do you ask yourself most often?

2. If you ever use an artificial intelligence assistant to study, which of the class's eight questions do you ask yourself while you use it?

3. Which branch would you like to see grow on the tree? Why?

Practice

1. Choose something from your daily life, such as your clothes or money, and ask it three questions from three different branches.

2. Which of Aristotle's kinds of knowledge (knowing, acting or making) would you put each of these in? Deciding whether to tell a secret you were trusted with. Learning to make a table. Studying why the stars shine.

3. The four questions on the timeline of the previous class (what is everything made of?, how should one live?, how do faith and reason fit together?, what can I know for certain?): which branch does each one belong to?

Keep thinking

When the world changes, philosophy grows new branches. Which change of today do you think will grow the next one? And what question would that branch ask?

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